



Learning that leads to action.

Emotional Intelligence at Work



Learning Outcomes

- ❑ Identify the importance of Emotional Intelligence (EQ) in the workplace
- ❑ Use the SCARF model to identify and minimize threat response for increased EQ

Note: Open and Download Participant Guide from the chat





Agenda

- 10 min** Introduction
- 22 min** Self-Awareness, Self-Regulation, & Empathy
- 25 min** SCARF Model
- 3 min** Closing

Note: Open and Download Participant Guide from the chat





Poll

Have you had a great leader or mentor in your career?

No, I have not

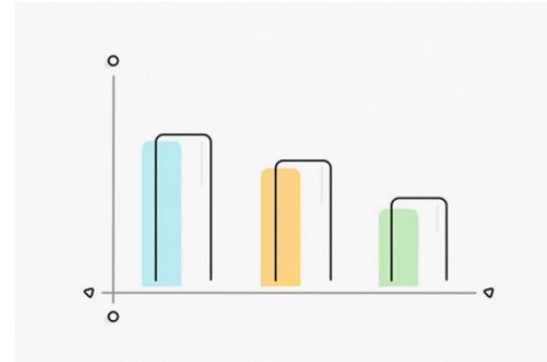
I am not sure

Maybe one?

Definitely at least one

Absolutely, several

Note: Open and Download Participant Guide from the chat





Leadership Skills

What do you think are the top **2-3** most important leadership skills?

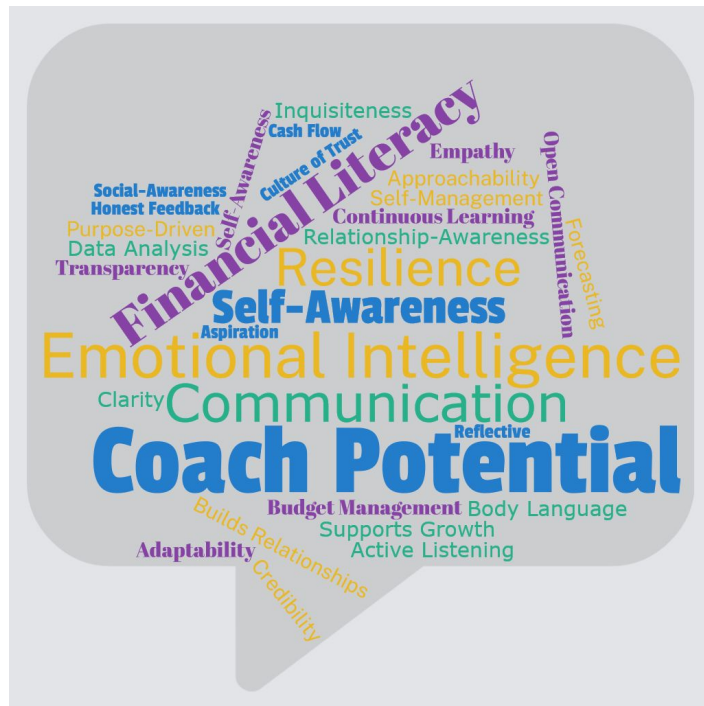




Leadership Skills

Top 7 Leadership Skills*

1. **Emotional Intelligence**
2. Communication
3. Ability to Coach Performance
4. Self-Awareness
5. Resilience
6. Financial Literacy
7. Technical Literacy



*[Harvard Business School Online: The 6 Leadership Skills You Need for Business Success](#)

Pillars of EQ



10-34 - area for enrichment/improvement

35-44 - functioning effectively, but not yet a strength

45-50 - a strength to lean into

What about your quiz results stood out to you, shocked you, or raised questions for you?



What are your Core Values?

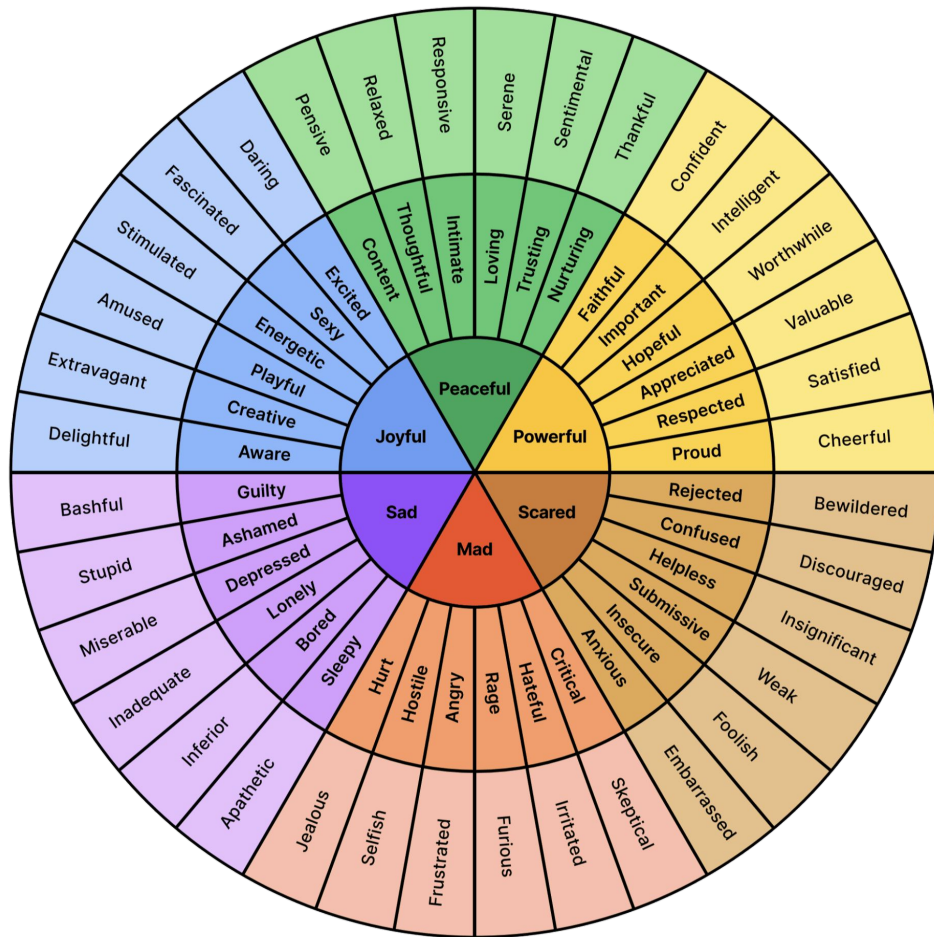
Authenticity
Achievement
Adventure
Authority
Autonomy
Balance
Beauty
Boldness
Compassion
Challenge
Citizenship
Community
Competency
Contribution
Creativity
Curiosity
Determination
Fairness
Faith

Fame
Friendships/Family
Fun
Growth
Happiness
Honesty
Humor
Influence
Inner Harmony
Justice
Kindness
Knowledge
Leadership
Learning
Love
Loyalty
Meaningful Work
Openness
Optimism

Peace
Pleasure
Poise
Popularity
Recognition
Religion
Reputation
Respect
Responsibility
Security
Self-Respect
Service
Spirituality
Stability
Success
Status
Trustworthiness
Wealth
Wisdom

Emotional Wheel

1. Pick three emotions to describe how you feel when your values are acknowledged and respected.
2. Pick three emotions to describe how you feel when your values are challenged.
3. How do you react when your values are challenged?



Triggered Communication Responses



FIGHT

"I want to prove why I'm right"

- Interrupting
- Gaslighting
- Hyper-aggression
- Lack of listening skills
- Controlling behaviors

FLIGHT

"I don't want to deal with this"

- Avoidance
- Deflecting
- Putting issues off
- Not wanting to talk
- Perfectionism



FREEZE

"I don't know what to do"

- Feeling stuck
- Feeling numb
- Dissociation
- Not listening
- Not replying

FAWN

"I want everyone to be happy"

- No boundaries
- Lack of assertiveness
- Prone to codependency
- Negotiating against self
- Saying "yes" to everything





How Do You Respond When Triggered?

- 1. Reflect on the times when you felt triggered / your values were challenged and went to the fight/flight/freeze/fawn response.**

- What set you off?
- How did you feel?
- Which one of the four F's was your response?
- What did you do and/or say?
- What was the outcome?



- 2. Based on these experiences, identify your 2 – 3 triggers.**



How Do You Respond When Triggered?

- 1. Think about the times when you felt triggered / your values were challenged and how you responded (fight/flight/freeze/fawn response).**
 - Is there another way to respond?
 - What can you do when you become aware of your emotions?
 - How can the outcome be different?
- 2. Identify TWO action items you can try next time you feel triggered/your values are challenged.**



Breakout Check-In

1. What are your insights from your self-reflections?

- Your values
- Your triggers
- Your emotions
- Your responses/reactions



2. What TWO actions have you come up with?



Empathy Vs. Sympathy

Empathy is feeling *with* people

Empathy is a vulnerable choice to connect

Rarely can a response make something better - what makes something better is connection.

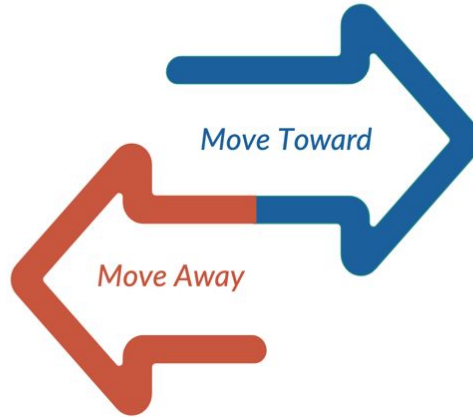




What Gets in the Way?

Our defensive styles and our stories

Feels Threat



Feels Reward



Away

&

Toward



SCARF & Defensive Styles

The SCARF model

A large, bold, green letter 'S' representing the 'S' in SCARF.

STATUS

Looks at the relative importance of people

A large, bold, orange letter 'C' representing the 'C' in SCARF.

CERTAINTY

Looks at our ability to predict the future. How certain are we?

A large, bold, green letter 'A' representing the 'A' in SCARF.

AUTONOMY

Looks at our perception of having control over our environment

A large, bold, yellow letter 'R' representing the 'R' in SCARF.

RELATEDNESS

Looks at our relationships and sense of fitting in

A large, bold, blue letter 'F' representing the 'F' in SCARF.

FAIRNESS

Looks at our perception of being treated fairly; for you and for others

Take a look at these five social domains—Status, Certainty, Autonomy, Relatedness, Fairness—**choose one or two** that are most important for you and **share in the chat**.

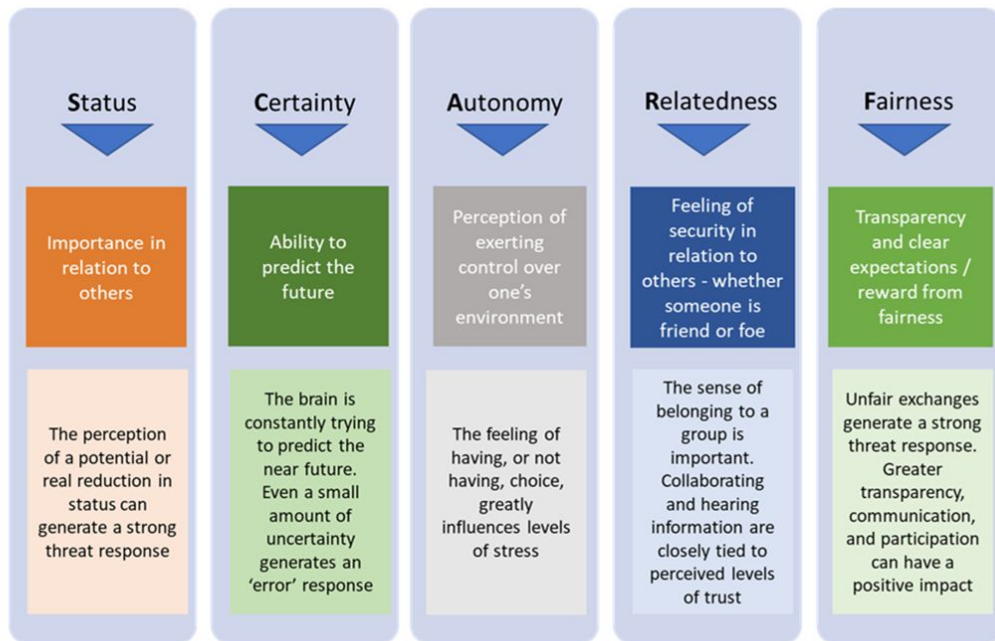


SCARF Discussion

BREAK
OUT

1. Thinking back to your value trigger exercise – what SCARF domains were active for you?

2. How can you respond more effectively when triggered, using the SCARF model?





Leadership in Practice

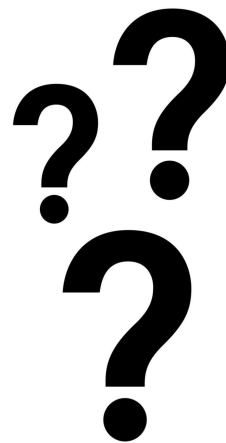
Using the SCARF model, how can you respond in these challenging situations?

Two departments are being asked to collaborate closely on a new initiative. One team worries they won't have much say in the process. The other team is concerned about taking on an extra workload.

- Which SCARF domains might be threatened?
- How could you, as the leader, respond in ways that reduce those threats and build collaboration?



Breakout Rooms



1. **Read the scenario** together in your group.
2. **Discuss:** Using the **SCARF model**, identify:
 - Which domains might feel threatened?
 - How could a leader respond in ways that reduce threat and build trust?
3. **Choose one person** to share your group's key ideas when we return.

** You'll have 4 minutes in your breakout room.*



Debrief

1. What approaches did you group come up with, and which **SCARF** domains did you see come into play?
2. What felt challenging about applying the **SCARF model** in your scenario?





Let's put SCARF into practice:

Using the SCARF model, how can you respond in these challenging situations?

Case Study 1: Senior leadership has shared an update that shifts priorities...

Case Study 2: You notice that one of your consistently strong team members has...

Case Study 3: You've recently been promoted into a manager role where you're...

Case Study 4: One of your team members shares that they don't feel included...

Case Study 5: During a quarterly check-in, a team member is struggling...

Case Study 6: You've been asked to lead a cross-functional project team...





Actionable Takeaways

1. Use **SCARF** as a self-awareness checklist
2. Use **SCARF** as a collaboration checklist
3. Actively reduce threats and increase rewards

BE A BETTER LEADER WITH SCARF

SCARF represents five areas influencing human behavior. The human brain wants to minimize danger or maximize reward which activate respective responses. It explains and helps to deal with human reactions, motivations, and interactions.

	Reward state activators	Threat state activators
S tatus Relative importance to others, personal worth	Positive and mutual feedback, public acknowledgment	Critique, unsolicited advice
C ertainty Ability to predict the future	Clear goals and expectations, feasible schedules	Non-transparent, dishonest and unpredictable behavior
A utonomy Sense of control over events	Providing choices, empowerment, self-responsibility, self-organization	Micromanagement, command and control
R elatedness Feeling safe around others	Mentoring, enabling socializations	Internal competition, prohibition of socializing
F airness Perception of people interactions fairness	Transparent decisions and communication, clear rules	Unequal conditions, lack of rules and communication



What's Next?

- ❏ Post session materials
- ❏ Grow @ Saga session on Radical Candor in **November**
- ❏ Complete feedback survey

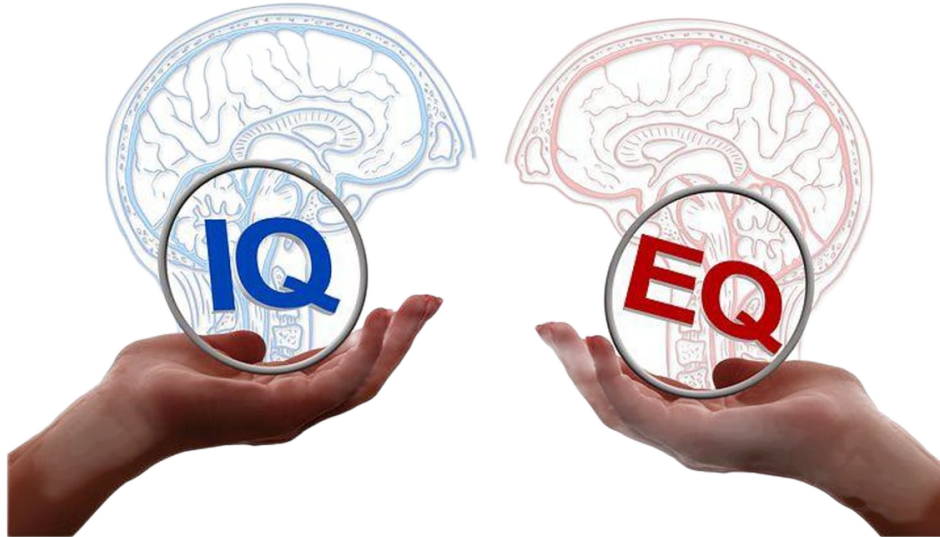


Thank you.



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What is Emotional Intelligence?



1

Self-awareness

The ability to understand your own emotions, strengths, and limitations

- Emotional self-awareness

2

Self-management

Allows to manage the emotions and reproduce the desired response

- Emotional self-control
- Adaptability
- Achievement orientation
- Positive outlook

3

Motivation

Enjoying what you are doing, working towards achieving goals, and exceeding the expectations set for you

- Goals and guides

4

Social awareness

The ability to accurately sense how other people feel about a situation

- Empathy
- Organizational awareness

5

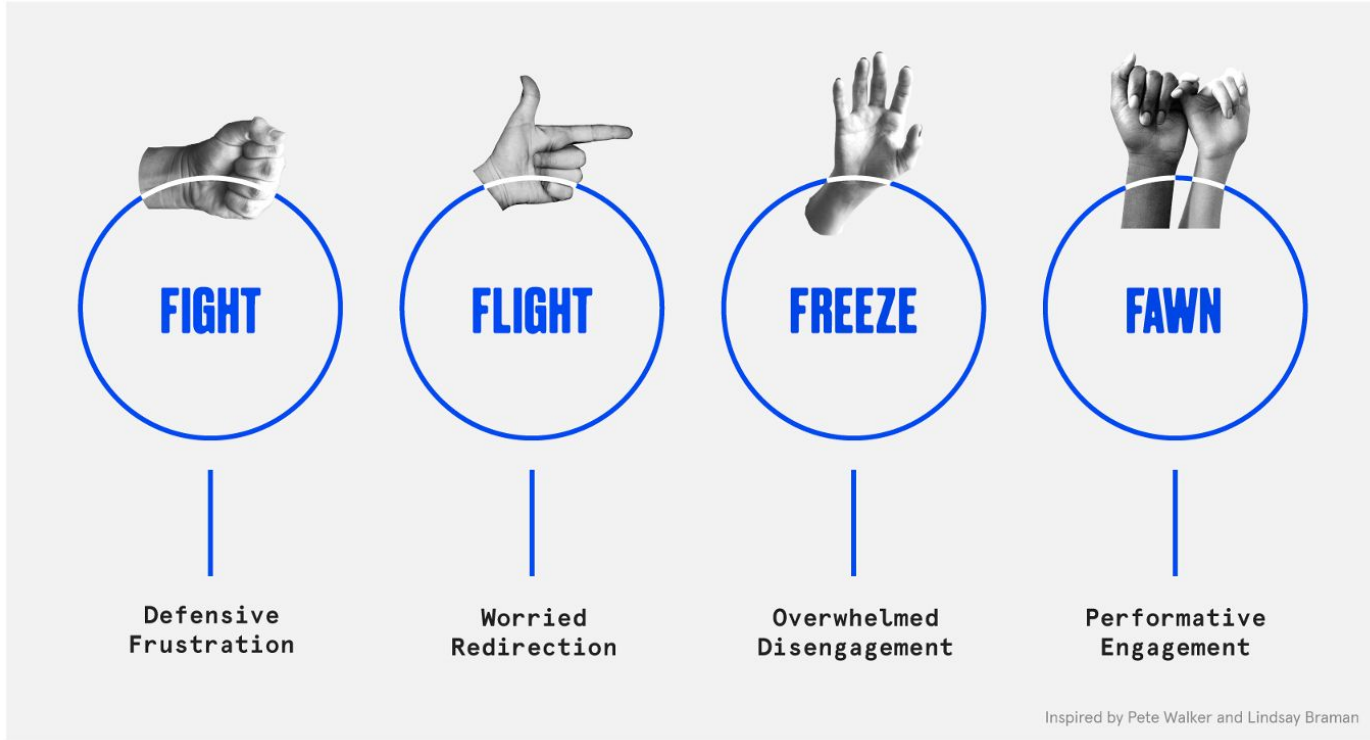
Social skills

Allows to manage relationships that benefit everyone involved

- Influence
- Coach and mentor
- Conflict management
- Teamwork
- Inspirational leadership



Triggered Communication Responses





Empathy at Work

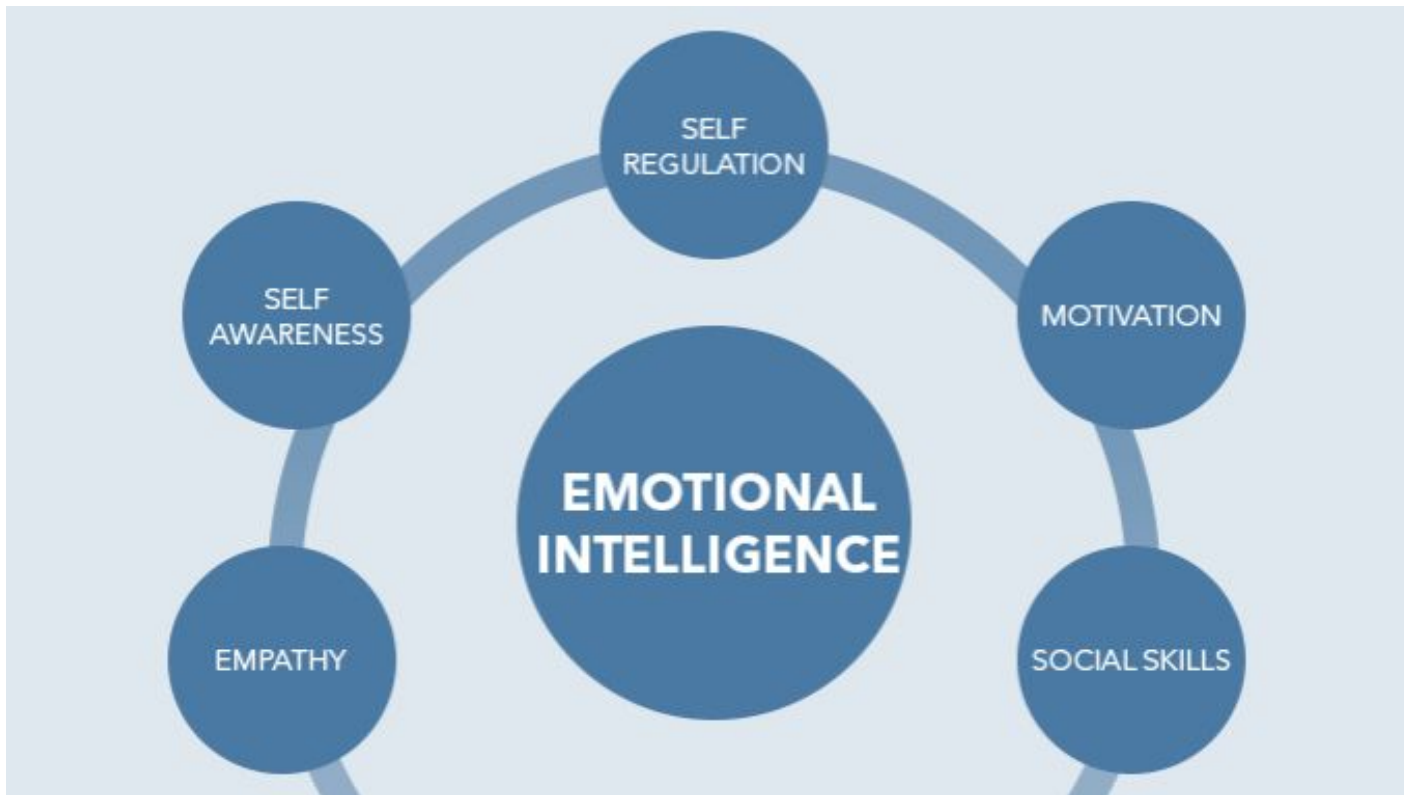
- 1. Take a moment to reflect on your interactions with someone you know at work (colleague, direct report, supervisor).**
 - I. What do you think their top priorities or goals are? How is their success being measured?
 - II. What are some organizational pressures that affect their work?
 - III. What do you know about their relationship with their supervisor? Positive/supportive or critical/difficult?
 - IV. What is happening in their personal life?
 - V. Given all of the above, what might they be feeling?
- 1. Think back on your own life and identify an experience where you had that feeling. How might you use that as a bridge to extend empathy to this person?**
- 2. Knowing what you know now, how can you self-regulate your responses in a triggered situation?**



[self-awareness]

*"The ability to take an honest look
at your life without attachment
to it being right or wrong."*

- Debbie Ford





Self-Regulation

You can't reason with
the nervous system. It
has a mind of its own.
But you can listen close,
when it tells you what
it needs to self-regulate.
Listen in, and honor its
requests to the letter.

That's where the
healing happens. In the
listening.

Jeff Brown

Empathy has no script.
There is no right way or wrong way to do it. It's simply listening, holding space, withholding judgment, emotionally connecting, and communicating that incredibly healing message of "You're not alone."

- Brené Brown

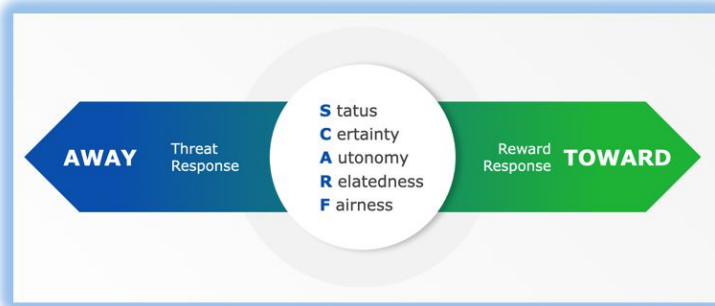
PsychDaily





To implement the SCARF model effectively, leaders can follow these practical steps:

1. Assess your current leadership approach, identifying areas lacking the SCARF domains.
2. Create an action plan that addresses each domain, focusing on improving specific aspects.
3. Set measurable goals and prioritize initiatives to ensure you make meaningful progress.
4. Encourage a culture of continuous improvement.



← DETECTS A THREAT, MOVES AWAY

DETECTS A REWARD, MOVES TOWARD →

This change could *undermine* my *authority*, or *damage* my *influence* within my team.

S

If this is successful it could earn me a *promotion*, or put me in *good standing* with my manager.

A lot could go wrong here. I'm not sure I *trust* the leader of this initiative/implementation. I detect *risk*.

C

The outcome(s) promised seem *achievable*. The metrics look *plausible* and the timelines look *reasonable*.

My opinion doesn't matter. I can't make a meaningful contribution or control the outcome. I have *no choice*..

A

I feel *involved* and my contributions are *valued*. Meaningful *choices* have been left open for me.

I feel *disconnected* and *segregated* from what's happening. It's going on around me, but I feel *excluded*.

R

I have ways to *interact* and *connect* with others to share my knowledge and experience. People *listen* to me.

I'm being asked to do *more work* with *no compensation* or recognition. It seems to be *their way* or the highway!

F

Expectations are *reasonable*. The project seems *well thought-out*. Everyone's *input* has been considered.